careful verification and consequences of report being false or untrue would be serious.

Ammini Kutty, a sub-inspector on security duty of Mariam Rasheeda could not identify the IB officials who threatened Rasheeda. The SI said after threatening Rasheeda, the IB officers brought four photographs and kept Srivastava's photograph in the set and asked Rasheeda to identify the photograph (of Srivastava), which she did. 'This clearly is questionable, illegal and unprofessional method adopted by the IB officials to get Srivastava's photograph identified under pressure.'

G Babu Raj, who was part of the Kerala Police team headed by Siby Mathews, said the IB did not share the result of their interrogation of the accused with his team. When Chandrasekhar was being interrogated by the IB at Latex Guest House, Trivandrum, Babu Raj said he visited the place and found a bunch of hair lying in the bathroom and felt like vomiting. He stated that the IB had already come to the conclusion regarding the involvement of Srivastava in the espionage case even before the case was registered, and, therefore, he did not feel it necessary to verify the facts. He told the CBI that 'it was difficult on our part to digest the above conclusion of the IB, but we were helpless.'

Babu Raj said he showed Fauziyya the photograph of K L Bhasin, and she readily identified as that of the person she had seen at Army Club, Bangalore and has been referring to as 'Brigadier Srivastava'. He said he was convinced that the person whom Fauziyya had met at Bangalore along with Sharma was none other than K L Bhasin.

Siby Mathews, who was in charge of the investigation, wrote a letter to the DGP, Kerala, saying the special team has not conducted any investigation on Srivastava. 'During discussion with officers of IB at the office of DGP (Intelligence) and also with your good self, I have mentioned that without some incriminating evidence, it is highly embarrassing to inquire about the alleged role of the IGP. The officers of IB have not disclosed the grounds for the allegations against the IGP.'